



Member Induction and Refresher Programme – 2026

Swearing in Ceremony

	Title	Session Overview	Lead Officer	Date
1	Welcome Evening	This event is Councillors' official Swearing in Ceremony and Declaration of Acceptance of Office. All Councillors will have their official photograph taken, and new Members will collect ICT equipment and submit their payroll documents. It is essential for all Members to attend this slot.	Ibrahim Ibrahim, Head of Support and Member Services	11 May 2026

One-off Events

	Title	Session Overview	Lead Officer	Date
2	Members Fair	This session will introduce you to the Council Directorates: • Adult Social Care and Public Health • Assistant Chief Executive • Change and Innovation • Children's Services • Finance • Growth and Place • Resident Services Executive Directors and their teams, will provide an overview of their area and answer any questions Members may have.	Ibrahim Ibrahim, Head of Support and Member Services	13 May 2026

Introductory and Refresher Training

Title	Session Overview	Lead Officer	Date
An Overview of the Constitution, Ethics, and Code of Conduct	This session provides a brief overview of the council's Constitution and the procedures which govern how the council operates and how decisions are made, followed by a more in-depth look at the general principles of conduct expected of all councillors and your specific obligations in relation to the Code of Conduct. Following the elections, a separate session on civility in public life will take place, where we can delve deeper into the principles with live examples. <i>Mandatory session for all Members.</i>	Abdus Choudhury, Director of Law and Governance	May 2026
Personal Safety	At the end of this session you will have an awareness of the potential personal safety risks related to your role as a Councillor, you will receive guidance on where to go for advice and support, and how to report an incident. This session will also include how to report incidents, and access to the council's check before check register (CBCR).	Suzy Lamplugh Trust	May 2026
Cyber Security Training	<i>Mandatory session for all Members.</i>	ICT	May 2026
Committee Procedure Rules	An introduction to decision making, and the procedure rules (standing orders) that govern how the council operates. The session will look in detail at the rules of debate, voting, motions and public participation.	Abdus Choudhury, Director of Law and Governance	June 2026

Title	Session Overview	Lead Officer	Date
Introduction to Customer Services	This session will include an overview of the Council's contact centre and the customer services teams. In the session we will also cover the services that are available and how we can help residents to access them.	Simon Batchelor, Assistant Director of Customer Services	June 2026
Transformation Programme Briefing	A briefing on the council's ambitious transformation programme.	Ana Popovici, Deputy Chief Executive	June 2026
Introduction to Local Authority Finance	The key elements of local government finance including, how we are funded, what we spend our money on, and how we allocate our resources.	Fenella Merry, Executive Director for Finance	June 2026
Emergency Planning and Civil Emergencies	Under the Civil Contingencies Act, Wandsworth Council is a 'Category 1 Responder' to emergencies. This briefing will show elected Members: • What that duty means • How the Council executes the duty and works with multi-agency partners to plan for, respond to and recover from emergencies • How the Council supports communities through emergencies and unexpected events • The role of Elected Members in emergencies This session will be workshop based.	Jo Robb, Head of Emergency Planning	June 2026

Title	Session Overview	Lead Officer	Date
Safeguarding - A Councillors Role and Responsibilities	Councillors should attend to understand their roles and responsibilities in relation to safeguarding children and adults at risk in Wandsworth. By the end of the session, Members should understand: In respect of children • Understand what child abuse and neglect is • Recognise the signs and indicators of child abuse, neglect and exploitation • Know what to do if they identify concerns about child abuse or neglect or a resident asks them for advice about child safeguarding issues • Understand the role and responsibilities of the local authority, elected Members and partners in safeguarding children • Know the role and responsibilities of the Executive Director of Children Services (Wandsworth) and other key officers in Safeguarding Children • Consider how elected Members can contribute to safeguarding children in their role In respect of adults • Understand the definition and types of abuse of adults at risk with care and support needs • Recognise the signs and indicators of abuse, neglect and exploitation of adults • Know what to do if they identify concerns about an adult with care and support needs • Understand the role and responsibilities of the local authority, elected Members and partners in safeguarding adults at risk • Consider how elected Members can contribute to safeguarding adults at risk in their role	Children's and Adults	July 2026

Title	Session Overview	Lead Officer	Date
Managing Casework	As a Councillor you will manage casework from your constituents. For new and returning Councillors accessing the necessary information and support to respond to constituent concerns can be daunting. This session will aim to help Councillors to navigate the Council's systems as well as identify sources of information and support. Ahead of this session, we will also share key contacts and FAQs for Members as part of the induction booklet.	Ibrahim Ibrahim, Head of Support and Member Services	July 2026
Managing information and serving residents (GDPR training)	As a Councillor you will speak to and help resolve some of your residents' queries and act on behalf of Wandsworth Council. This will involve the management of data, and to ensure that you are fully equipped with the right data protection understanding and skills, a session has been created to help inform you about these types of activities. In this session you will learn what UK GDPR is, how it affects you in your various roles as a Councillor, what is required by you as a data controller, how to manage requests for data and what part you play in any Freedom of Information requests that may be received.	Katrina Waite	July 2026
Civility in Public Life	Members will learn more about the Nolan Principles and the application of these in the context of performing their role as Councillors, with some live examples.	Abdus Choudhury, Director of Law and Governance	September/October 2026

Title	Session Overview	Lead Officer	Date
Corporate Parenting - A Councillor's Role and Responsibilities	Members play a crucial role in ensuring that as a Local Authority we are not only meeting our duties to children in care and care leavers, but going above and beyond in securing positive outcomes and futures they can look forward to. In the training we will cover; who are children in care and care leavers; what is Corporate Parenting; how Councillors can play their part; and the Role of the Corporate Parenting Panel and its members.	Children Services	September 2026
Climate Change - The Essentials	This session will provide an overview of the role of Wandsworth Council in tackling the Climate Emergency. It will outline the council's ambitious targets for carbon neutrality and climate resilience by 2030, and how we aim to meet them as a Council. It will also introduce the further Carbon Literacy accredited training available to interested Members.	Andrew Hagger	September 2026
Community Leadership and Engagement	For new councillors in particular the Community Leadership offer provides a number of resources to support Members in their role as community leaders, facilitators and advocates. This session will be delivered jointly by the LGA and a Member Peer.	LGA	September 2026
Handling complaints	Introduction to the council's corporate complaint process, and the involvement of councillors.	Katrina Waite, Head of Resident Engagement and DPO	October 2026

Title	Session Overview	Lead Officer	Date
Introduction to Equality, Diversity and Inclusion	Promoting equality involves much more than simply treating everyone alike. It requires recognition that some groups have particular needs that must be met to ensure genuine equality of access or opportunity. This includes considering the needs of those who come from a position of longstanding disadvantage and discrimination. Some aspects of a Councillor's role will have a big impact on the opportunities and experiences of residents. These include the way Members communicate with residents, how they consider different people's needs when taking decisions, and in scrutiny of Council decisions and services. It is also about how you behave amongst your peers. This session will give Members the background and preparation needed to ensure we meet our legal and corporate objectives in relation to equality and inclusion.	Janice Frazer, Organisational Development / External	October 2026
Supporting older and vulnerable residents	How to support older people through social isolation and loneliness. Understand how to support for older people facing financial hardship.	ASC&PH	November 2026
Housing register, advice and homelessness	Develop a good understanding of the main housing legislation and how to help residents. This session will also focus on how to deal with complex housing casework and how best to support residents.	Resident Services	November 2026
Highways and transport	An understanding of the council's role in traffic management. Awareness of the responsibilities of the council and partner organisations.	Growth and Place	December 2026

Title	Session Overview	Lead Officer	Date
Finance – Budget Setting Process	This session will set out how the council sets its budgets, and the council tax setting process.	Fenella Merry, Executive Director for Finance	December 2026
Social Media Training	Social media training for members involves training on content creation, platform specifics (Meta, TikTok, LinkedIn), and how to delve into the data. This session will also give Members an overview of the council's communication strategy, protocols and process; the methods we use to reach out to a diverse range of communities and stakeholders with some examples of the type of campaigns we run.	INTERNAL / EXTERNAL	January 2027
Finance – HRA	This session will focus on the Housing Revenue Account, how the money is spent, and how resources are allocated.	TBC	January 2027
Introduction to Procurement	An opportunity to gain an understanding of the Councils approach to procuring new contracts of all sizes to ensure value for money, transparency, and social value.	Mark Glaister	February 2027
Introduction to Employment, Skills, and Learning	In this session, Members will learn about the critical work being led and managed by Wandsworth Council to improve employment and skills outcomes and to equalise opportunities for Wandsworth young people and adults. Members will get the most up to date picture of employment and skills, as well as information about key service areas: adult and community learning; apprenticeships; employment support, and young careers and pathways.	Chantelle Daniel	March 2027

Title	Session Overview	Lead Officer	Date
Public Speaking Training	Public speaking training teaches Members to communicate clearly, engage audiences, and manage difficult situations through helpful techniques, using body language, vocal projection, storytelling, and handling Q&A, boosting confidence.	EXTERNAL	April 2027
Introduction to s106 and CIL funding	S106 training for members will help introduce Section 106 agreements, legal pacts between developers and local authorities to mitigate development impacts, covering affordable housing, infrastructure (education, green space, roads).	Nazeya Hussain	May 2027
Governance and Scrutiny	Focus on building essential abilities such as thorough preparation and research, effective argument development, and attentive critical listening.	CfGS	<i>Date to be confirmed following local elections.</i>

Information Technology Drop-in Sessions

Title	Session Overview	Lead Officer	Date
Member ICT support sessions	These ICT Drop in Sessions have been organised for Councillors to receive 1-1 or group support on a range of IT based issues.	ICT	<i>Ongoing</i>

Committee Training

Title	Session Overview	Lead Officer	Date
Training for Planning members 4 June 2026	The planning application process is of great interest to residents, and all Members (not just those sitting on the Committees) will need to understand how it operates. This session will explain how the system works, how Members and their constituents can influence it, and provide guidance on what issues the planning system covers. The first half of the session is designed for all Members, with the second half specifically for Committee members, but all Members are welcome to attend both parts. The session is mandatory for all Members of the Committee.	Nazeya Hussain (ED for Growth and Place), Nick Calder, Head of Development Management (Wandsworth)	4 June 2026
Training for Licensing Committee Members	This training will cover the background to the Licensing Committee; the types of decisions that are made; how members of the public can get involved; the hearing and decision-making process; and the legal background. This training is mandatory for Committee Members and will be useful for Members who wish to give information and advice on how to comment on applications in their area or raise issues where premises are causing problems. THIS SESSION WILL BE DELIVERED JOINTLY WITH RICHMOND	RSP – TBC	W/C 1 June 2026
Executive	Specific training may be necessary to enable the Cabinet to fulfil their responsibilities with greater effectiveness. This could include areas such as public speaking or strengthening relationships between officers and councillors. A comprehensive training needs assessment will be conducted following the election.	TBC	TBC

Ward and Neighbourhoods

Title	Session Overview	Lead Officer	Date
Finding out about your ward (DataWand)	This session will outline the data, reports and dashboards available at a Ward level, plus show the latest online mapping tools.	Change and Innovation	May 2026

External Offer

Title	Session Overview	Lead	Date
LGA	The LGA will be delivering events for newly elected councillors. It will be an opportunity to explore what your role means; learn about challenges facing Councils; and meet colleagues from other areas. The LGA will continue to offer courses, such as: - Personal safety for councillors - Handling online abuse and intimidation for councillors	Local Government Association	<i>Ongoing</i>
LGiU	The Local Government Information Unit (LGiU) organises various events for councillors, including workshops and training sessions, such as: - Chairing skills - Local government finance essentials - Questioning skills for scrutiny - Tackling disinformation and misinformation	LGiU	<i>Ongoing</i>